
Platelet-Rich Plasma (PRP) for Chronic Pain: Patient Information Leaflet

[PRP procedure is not covered by the Province]

What is PRP?

Platelet-Rich Plasma (PRP) is a treatment that uses your own blood cells to help promote healing and reduce pain. A small sample of your blood is taken. It is spun in a machine to concentrate platelets (healing cells). The PRP is injected into the painful area. Platelets release growth factors that may help repair damaged tissues such as tendons, ligaments, and joints.

What conditions can PRP help?

PRP works best for certain chronic (long-lasting) conditions:

Strongest evidence

- Knee Osteoarthritis
- Lateral Epicondylitis in the Elbow (Tennis Elbow)
- Patellar Tendinopathy

Moderate evidence

- Rotator Cuff Tendinopathy in the shoulder
- Hip Osteoarthritis
- Plantar Fasciitis in the foot



Red Sands Pain Management
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Less certain benefits

- Achilles Tendinopathy
- Greater Trochanteric Pain Syndrome
- Some types of low back pain (disc or facet related)

What happens during the procedure?

- Blood is drawn from your arm (like a routine blood test)
- The sample is processed to concentrate platelets in a special machine to produce PRP
- At Red Sands we use **Ultrasound Guidance** to accurately inject the PRP in the target area

The procedure usually takes 30–60 minutes.

When will I feel better?

- Pain may increase for a few days after injection
- Improvement usually starts within 2–6 weeks
- Maximum benefit may take 3–6 months

PRP works gradually by promoting healing—not by numbing pain immediately.



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How effective is PRP?

Many patients experience moderate pain relief and improved function for 6-12 months. Results vary depending on:

- The condition being treated
- Severity of damage
- Rehabilitation physical therapy participation

Will I need more than one injection?

- Some patients improve after one injection - up to 6 months
- Others may need 2–3 treatments spaced weeks apart - for up to 12 months relief
- Your doctor will advise what is best for you.

Risks and side effects

PRP is generally safe because it uses your own blood. Possible side effects include:

- Temporary pain or swelling at the injection site
- Bruising
- Stiffness



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Rare risks:

- Infection
- Nerve or tissue irritation

Who may not be suitable?

PRP may not be recommended if you:

- Have active infection
- Have certain blood disorders
- Have advanced joint damage

Aftercare

- Rest the treated area for a few days
- Avoid anti-inflammatory medications (e.g., ibuprofen) for 1–2 weeks
- Gradually return to activity
- Physiotherapy is often recommended

Cost and coverage

PRP is not covered by provincial health plan/Medicare. Costs vary depending on the number of injections. Please ask our clinic for current pricing.



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Key points to remember

- PRP uses your body's natural healing system
- It works best for tendon injuries and early arthritis
- Improvement takes time (weeks to months)
- Results vary between individuals

Contact your care team before/after procedure:

Phone: 782-377-7813



[Info@redsandspm.com](mailto:info@redsandspm.com)

In an emergency:

→ Call 911, or visit your local emergency department

Disclaimer

This information is for general guidance only. It is not a substitute for professional medical advice. Always follow the specific instructions given by your healthcare provider and discuss any questions or concerns you have about your treatment.